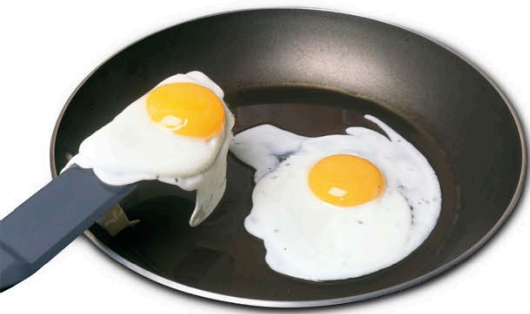




Non-stick frying pans

- **What?** Teflon™
- **Who?** Roy Plunkett
- **Where and when?** US, 1938

Like many other inventions, the coating that gives frying pans a nonstick surface was discovered by accident. While researching gases for use in refrigerators at the chemical company DuPont, the American chemist Roy Plunkett stumbled upon polytetrafluoroethylene—a super-slippery substance. Later called Teflon™, the material was applied to frying pans, and has been a boon to pancake

flippers ever since.



Keeping food fresh

- **What?** Tupperware®
- **Who?** Earl Tupper
- **Where and when?** US, 1946

The period just after World War II saw the creation of a number of products for keeping food fresh. These included plastic fridge boxes, Tupperware®, which had airtight lids and a patented “burping seal.” Named after their American inventor, Earl Tupper, the boxes became popular in the 1950s through “Tupperware parties,” pioneered by saleswoman Brownie Wise, held in people’s homes.

Superfast cooking

- **What?** Microwave oven
- **Who?** Percy Spencer
- **Where and when?** US, 1945

The American engineer Percy Spencer was experimenting with a magnetron (a device that emits microwaves) when he found that a chocolate bar in his pocket had mysteriously melted. Spencer realized that the microwaves were causing water molecules in the

chocolate bar to vibrate, creating heat and cooking it. The company he worked for, Raytheon, turned his discovery into a new type of cooker—the microwave oven.



RadaRange, an early microwave oven, c.1958

AT HOME

Cutting and chopping

- **What?** Food processor
- **Who?** Pierre Verdon
- **Where and when?** France, 1971



Modern food processor

Kitchen food mixers for kneading bread dough and whisking liquids had been around since 1919. But it was not until many decades later that the French engineer Pierre Verdon developed the first food processor, a machine capable of chopping, blending, and mixing solid foods. Verdon called his labor-saving processor the Magimix.